IELTS Grammar Quick Revision

Quick rules, memory tricks and examples.

Sentence Pattern

Rule: S+V(+O/C/A). Trick: Find the verb first, then ask Who?=Subject, What/Whom?=Object, What is/looks like?=Complement, When/Where/How/Why?=Adverbial.

Example: The students studied English in the library.

Tenses

Rule: Present Simple=facts/habits; Present Continuous=now; Present Perfect=past+present; Past Simple=finished past; Past Continuous=ongoing past; Future Simple=will+V1.

Example: I study. I am studying. I have studied. I studied. I was studying. I will study.

Conditionals

Rule: 0: If+Present, Present (facts). 1: If+Present, will V1. 2: If+Past, would V1. 3: If+had V3, would have V3.

Example: If I study, I will pass.

Passive Voice

Rule: Object + be + V3. Keep the tense.

Example: The road was built in 2010.

Modal Verbs

Rule: Modal + V1 always.

Example: You should study. You must wear a seat belt.

Articles

Rule: First mention=a/an. Second mention/specific/unique=the. General plurals & uncountables=no article.

Example: I bought a book. The book is useful. Water is essential.

Gerunds & Infinitives

Rule: enjoy/finish/avoid + V-ing. want/decide/hope + to V1.

Example: I enjoy reading. I want to study.

Prepositions

Rule: good at, interested in, depend on, responsible for, similar to, famous for, belong to, listen to.

Example: I am interested in AI.

Punctuation

Rule: Comma after introductory clause. Formal IELTS: avoid contractions.

Example: Although it rained, we played.